



Nouns (People, Places, and Things) • Practice 1

People, Places, and Things A noun is the name of a person, place, or thing.

People	Places	Things
carpenter	auditorium	<i>Those You Can See</i>
students	Grant's Tomb	hedgehog marigold
cheerleader	art gallery	ambulance blouse
Dr. Nelson	fish markets	<i>Those You Cannot See</i>
technician	Lincoln Center	warmth generosity
Canadians	Wrigley Building	sickness noise

Exercise 1

Recognizing People, Places, and Things. Put the words below in the proper columns.

EXAMPLE:

	<u>People</u>	<u>Places</u>	<u>Things</u>
			shoes
dictionary	Stephanie	garage	umbrella health
witness	mall	meadow	Eisenhower envelope
sister	helicopter	dinosaur	principal Babe Ruth
success	capitol	peanut	office restroom

People

Places

Things

_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Exercise 2

Using Nouns. Fill in the blank in each sentence with the kind of word indicated in the parentheses.

EXAMPLE: For Christmas I got a new calculator. (thing)

- My favorite _____ will arrive from Atlanta today. (person)
- When will you finish your _____? (thing)
- The Supreme Court is located in _____. (place)
- Until now my grandfather has always been in good _____. (thing)
- You will find many reference books in the _____. (place)
- Because of my poor handwriting, I need a _____. (thing)
- Her _____ is appreciated by everyone. (thing)
- My _____ makes the best chocolate cake. (person)
- I always buy new CD's at _____. (place)
- I believe the most important scientist was _____. (person)

Exercise 1 Classifying Nouns. All the words in the following list are nouns. Place each word in the correct column.

EXAMPLE:	People	Places	Things
			carrot
1. teacher	6. uprising	11. Maine	16. Mary Stuart
2. grizzly bear	7. Frank	12. fable	17. vegetables
3. sadness	8. ranch	13. flower	18. silliness
4. city	9. heroism	14. justice	19. Atlantic Ocean
5. basketball	10. newspaper	15. countryside	20. truth

People	Places	Things
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

Exercise 2 Classifying Nouns in Sentences. Complete each sentence by writing a noun in the blank. Then write the noun in the proper column below.

EXAMPLE: An encyclopedia is an excellent reference book.

People	Places	Things
		encyclopedia

- Fourteen _____ signed up for soccer tryouts.
- For their vacation, the Jeffersons went to _____.
- The _____ needs to be cleaned.
- Please pick up some _____ at the store.
- Jamie's _____ are coming to her house for a sleep-over.
- Would you like to eat lunch at the _____?
- Inez needs some new _____ for those pictures.
- The _____ broke when Alice dropped it.
- Let's invite _____ over for dinner.
- Josh and Frankie went swimming in the _____.

People	Places	Things
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

14.1

Nouns (Collective and Compound Nouns) • Practice 1

Collective Nouns A collective noun is a noun that names a group of individual people or things.

COLLECTIVE NOUNS		
squad	flock	crew
company	team	orchard

Compound Nouns A compound noun is made up of two or more words.

COMPOUND NOUNS	
workshop	Getty Museum
ice age	father-in-law

Exercise 1

Recognizing Collective Nouns. In each blank below, write the collective noun from the sentence.

EXAMPLE: The entire clan gathered in the hall. clan

1. An angry crowd assembled in front of the church. _____
2. My uncle hopes to raise a flock of sheep. _____
3. Our class voted to have a spring picnic. _____
4. Melissa applauded the performance of the orchestra. _____
5. What did you think about the reaction of the audience? _____
6. A company of dancers will entertain us first. _____
7. The jury voted to acquit the defendant. _____
8. Later, the trio played three interesting numbers. _____
9. A squadron of soldiers surrounded the building. _____
10. The bill was sent to a committee for further study. _____

Exercise 2

Recognizing Compound Nouns. In each blank below, write the compound noun from the sentence.

EXAMPLE: We definitely need a new football. football

1. My father wants to build new bookshelves. _____
2. Visit the Smithsonian Institution in Washington. _____
3. How late is the post office open on Saturday? _____
4. Her outlook is always positive. _____
5. How did your cousin like her new junior high school? _____
6. Paul Simon is my favorite songwriter. _____
7. To improve, we will need a lot of teamwork. _____
8. No medicine is a complete cure-all. _____
9. This cartridge uses an advanced magnetic tape. _____
10. We are going to assemble a new mailing list. _____



Nouns (Collective and Compound Nouns) • Practice 2

Exercise 1 Recognizing Collective Nouns. Underline the nouns in the following sentences. Circle the collective nouns.

EXAMPLE: Marie shocked the audience with her final words.

1. A panel of scientists debated the probability of life on other planets.
2. An outlandish sketch of an imaginary Martian amused the audience.
3. The performance of the team improved tremendously after the speech given by the coach.
4. Pickett led his brigade in a daring charge at Gettysburg.
5. William Shakespeare wrote his plays for one particular company of actors.
6. A pair of swans swam lazily around the lake.
7. The captain ordered new uniforms for the crew.
8. Christopher wants to join the army when he is eighteen.
9. Tony hired a jazz trio to play at the party.
10. An interesting speaker gave a presentation for the assembly today.
11. The entire herd had to be checked for disease.
12. An unruly mob moved quickly toward the jailhouse.
13. Members of the union were marching with signs in front of the store.
14. The singer approached the microphone, and the band began to play.
15. Melanie and her seven musical friends formed an octet.

Exercise 2 Recognizing Compound Nouns. Underline each compound noun in the following paragraph.

EXAMPLE: There is no way their high school can beat ours this year.

(1) Yesterday in homeroom, Bob and I discussed sports in our junior high school. (2) We agreed that our victory in volleyball was the highlight of the year. (3) Bob said he couldn't wait to go to high school, where we will be able to play basketball, water polo, and baseball. (4) I myself would like to be a linebacker on the football team.

Exercise 3 Writing Sentences With Compound Nouns. Write a sentence of your own that uses the type of compound noun given in parentheses. Then underline the compound noun.

EXAMPLE: (hyphenated words) Mel's great-grandmother likes to ski.

1. (separate words) _____
2. (hyphenated words) _____
3. (combined words) _____
4. (separate words) _____
5. (hyphenated words) _____
6. (combined words) _____
7. (separate words) _____
8. (hyphenated words) _____
9. (combined words) _____
10. (separate words) _____

Nouns (Common and Proper Nouns) • Practice 1

Common and Proper Nouns A common noun names any one of a class of people, places, or things. A proper noun names a specific person, place, or thing.

Common Nouns	Proper Nouns
soldier	General Eisenhower
theater	Globe Theater
opera	<i>Porgy and Bess</i>

Exercise 1

Recognizing Common and Proper Nouns. In the sentences below, underline each proper noun and circle each common noun.

EXAMPLE: Bruce Springsteen is an outstanding performer.

- Charles Dickens is easily my favorite British author.
- The touring cast of *South Pacific* arrived early.
- Did you know that Robert F. Kennedy once served as attorney general?
- My math teacher at Sarah J. Hale High School is very interesting.
- Recently, Thanksgiving was voted the most popular holiday.
- Long ago, Rome was the largest city.
- The library on Weldon Lane will be closed tomorrow.
- Euripides, the tragic poet, was born in 485 B.C.
- Andrew Carnegie built a very elaborate mansion.
- In soccer, Mia Hamm was peerless.

Exercise 2

Changing Common Nouns Into Proper Nouns. In the spaces provided below, supply a proper noun that illustrates the common noun.

EXAMPLE: A famous highway Pennsylvania Turnpike

Common Noun

Proper Noun

- A favorite book _____
- A former president _____
- A noted composer _____
- A baseball team _____
- A beautiful river _____
- A famous actor _____
- A news magazine _____
- A senator _____
- An exciting museum _____
- A famous bridge _____

Exercise 1 Identifying Common and Proper Nouns. Place a C after each common noun and a P after each proper noun. Write a proper noun that gives an example of each common noun. Then, write a common noun that gives an example of a class to which each proper noun belongs.

EXAMPLE: Mars P planet

- | | |
|----------------------------|---------------------|
| 1. writer _____ | 9. automobile _____ |
| 2. Chicago _____ | 10. Blondie _____ |
| 3. Zeus _____ | 11. state _____ |
| 4. river _____ | 12. singer _____ |
| 5. street _____ | 13. Rockies _____ |
| 6. Louisa May Alcott _____ | 14. relative _____ |
| 7. Jamaica _____ | 15. team _____ |
| 8. horse _____ | |

Exercise 2 Distinguishing Between Common and Proper Nouns. Each of the following items contains three nouns, one of which is a proper noun that has not been capitalized. Underline each proper noun.

EXAMPLE: lion leo kitten Leo

- | | | |
|---------------|-------------|-----------------|
| 1. car | convertible | studebaker |
| 2. state | district | dade county |
| 3. lake erie | ocean | river |
| 4. magazine | bible | pamphlet |
| 5. nation | ghana | country |
| 6. singer | songwriter | john lennon |
| 7. aunt sally | relative | woman |
| 8. character | tom sawyer | boy |
| 9. cartoon | movie | bambi |
| 10. poet | writer | emily dickinson |

Writing Application Writing Sentences With Nouns. Write five sentences of your own using each of the different types of nouns listed below. Underline these nouns.

EXAMPLE: a compound noun

The carpenter constructed a bookshelf for my room.

- a noun that names a place

- a noun that names a person

- a noun that names a thing you can see

- a noun that names an idea

- a collective noun
